

Privacy Policy

Sokoni Kenya · Effective January 2026

Your privacy matters to us. This policy explains exactly what data we collect, why we collect it, how we protect it, and the rights you have over it. We have written it in plain language — no legal jargon.

At a Glance

■ We collect only what is necessary to run the marketplace
■ We never sell your personal data to anyone, ever
■ Passwords are hashed — we cannot see or recover them
■ You can delete your account and all your data at any time
■ We do not use advertising or tracking technologies
■ All connections are encrypted using HTTPS

1. Information We Collect

- **Account information:** When you register, we collect your name, email address, phone number (optional), and role (buyer or seller). This is used to manage your account.
- **Listing content:** Product titles, descriptions, prices, categories, locations, and any photos you upload. This content is publicly visible on the platform.
- **Usage data:** Pages visited, searches made, and listings viewed. This helps us improve the product and detect fraudulent activity.
- **Payment data:** When you pay via M-Pesa, the transaction is processed by Safaricom. We receive a payment confirmation only — never your PIN, account balance, or full financial details.
- **Support messages:** Messages you send to our support team are stored securely and may be reviewed by our staff.

2. How We Use Your Information

- **To operate the platform:** managing your account, displaying your listings, enabling messaging, and processing payments.
- **For safety and moderation:** detecting fraud, reviewing listings, and investigating reports from other users.
- **To communicate with you:** transactional emails such as password resets, listing approvals, and payment confirmations.
- **To improve Sokoni Kenya:** aggregated, anonymised usage data helps us understand how to make the platform better.

3. Who We Share Data With

- **Payment processors:** Your phone number and transaction amount are shared with Safaricom (M-Pesa) to complete payments.
- **Email delivery:** We use a third-party email service to send you transactional emails. They receive your email address and email content only.
- **AI features (premium sellers only):** If you use our AI listing generator, your product details are sent to an AI provider to generate text. This provider does not use API data to train its models.

- We do not sell, rent, or share your personal data with advertisers, data brokers, or any unauthorised third parties.

4. Data Retention

- Active accounts: We retain your data for as long as your account is active.
- Inactive accounts: If you have not logged in for 24 months, we may anonymise or delete inactive data.
- Account deletion: When you delete your account, personal information is removed within 30 days. Some anonymised statistical data may be retained.
- Legal obligations: In certain circumstances we may be required to retain data longer to comply with Kenyan law or to resolve disputes.

5. Your Rights

- Access: You may request a copy of all personal data we hold about you.
- Correction: You can update most information in your account settings. Contact us for other corrections.
- Deletion: You may request full deletion of your account and personal data. We process this within 30 days.
- Opt-out: You can unsubscribe from non-essential emails at any time using the link in any email, or by contacting support.
- To exercise any of these rights, contact us at sokonikenya@gmail.com or via WhatsApp: 0701 059 192.

6. Security

- All data is transmitted over HTTPS (TLS encryption). Passwords are hashed using bcrypt — we cannot recover your password.
- Our systems use row-level access controls so users can only access their own data. Admin access requires separate privileged credentials.
- In the event of a data breach affecting your personal information, we will notify you within 72 hours and describe the steps being taken.

7. Cookies and Local Storage

- We use browser local storage (not cookies) to keep you logged in across sessions. This is cleared when you log out.
- We do not use advertising cookies, analytics trackers, or any third-party tracking technologies.
- Your display preference (light/dark mode) is stored locally on your device only.

8. Children's Privacy

- Sokoni Kenya is not intended for users under the age of 18. We do not knowingly collect data from minors.
- If you believe a minor has registered, please contact us at sokonikenya@gmail.com and we will delete the account promptly.

9. Changes to This Policy

- We may update this Privacy Policy from time to time. We will notify registered users of material changes by email at least 7 days before they take effect.
- Continued use of Sokoni Kenya after changes take effect constitutes your acceptance of the updated policy.

10. Contact

- Privacy questions or data requests: sokonikenya@gmail.com
- WhatsApp: 0701 059 192
- Support Centre: marketplace-kenya.pages.dev/support

Last updated: January 2026 · Sokoni Kenya · marketplace-kenya.pages.dev